CONSUMER DURABLES

SHUBHI KUMAR, 26
Pastry chef

ARCHIT UPPAL, 31
Businessman

Gurugram

What they bought

Bosch built-in induction **₹40,000**

Bosch built-in microwave, 25 litres **₹44,600**

Bosch wall-mounted hood **₹36,300**

Bosch built-in dishwasher **₹63,000**

Bosch built-in gas hob **₹34,000**

Carysil Quartz Workstation Sink with glass rinser, soap dispenser, three-way faucet & RO splint **₹50,000**

The couple, who got married in December, bought these appliances for their home in Gurugram. "We love to cook and host parties. We were very conscious that our open kitchen needed to be not just functional but also aesthetically pleasing," says Shubhi.



RAJWANT RAWAT

from 2020 to now, the increase most pronounced in the mid- and upper-end. It is the highest in the case of multi-purpose vehicles (MPVs), where prices have risen by nearly Rs 2.4 lakh from 2021 to now, followed by sedans (Rs 1.8 lakh) and SUVs (Rs 1.5 lakh). The average retail price of hatchbacks in the lower segment has gone up too, by around Rs 1.16 lakh in the same period. But, as Gaurav Vangaal, an analyst with S&P Global, says, "Consumers today do not mind paying extra as long as they get value for money. They also seem to be able to absorb the increase in prices." This is a sign of the market and the consumer maturing. Bhatia expects the trend to continue for some more time, with dealer discounts, easy finance and better road infrastructure facilitating people's move to premium cars.

In response to that demand, auto companies are flooding the consumer with a fleet of cars, with maximum launches in the premium category. Maruti, the undisputed leader in the sub-Rs 10 lakh and Rs 10-15 lakh cars, is beginning to eye a



SHWETA JAIN
Chief Business Officer, Luxury, Reserve & Craft, India & South Asia, Diageo

"TRADITIONALLY, INDIANS WOULD COMMENCE THEIR SCOTCH WHISKY JOURNEY WITH A RED LABEL. NOW MORE YOUNG PEOPLE ARE OPTING FOR PREMIUM VARIANTS"